



WINS AWARD — Andy Cohen is presented the Sportsman of the Year award at the annual Father-Son Awards dinner of Temple Mt. Sinai Men's Club Tuesday night. Presenting the trophy is Bob Nelson, left, to Cohen.
—(Times Staff Photo)

Andy Cohen Named El Paso Sportsman Of The Year

By CHUCK WHITLOCK

Andy Cohen, El Paso's gift to major league baseball and coach of the University of Texas at El Paso baseball team, Tuesday night was honored as Sportsman of the Year at the annual Father-Son Awards Dinner of Temple Mt. Sinai Men's Club.

Some 350 fathers and sons turned out to honor Cohen, who was kept in ignorance of the award until the final second.

Almost speechless at the announcement, Cohen was further dumbfounded at the sudden appearance of his wife Barbara who had been spirited into the all male gathering for the occasion.

Cohen, who was presented the award for his contribution to athletics in El Paso shared the spotlight with Texas A&M football coach Gene Stallings, All-America footballer Freddie Carr from U.T. El Paso, and pro golfer Lee Trevino.

Carr was named the outstanding amateur athlete of the year and Trevino professional at Horizon Hills Golf and Country Club was honored as the outstanding pro athlete of the year.

Trevino was in New York Tuesday night to receive his honor as Golf Digest Magazine Rookie of the Year. Jesse Whittenton of Horizon accepted it for Trevino.

Stallings, who lead "the miracle men of AggieLand" to a cotton Bowl victory over Alabama drew a standing ovation for an outstanding speech on the importance of athletics.

"All parents should give their youngsters opportunity to play athletics and if they don't want to they should make them play," Stallings said.

"Participation is the key in athletics. My biggest pride is when the youngster has done something. You can't put too much emphasis on an athletic program.

"I believe it to be one of the last frontiers-competitive athletics.

Announcement of Cohen's honor was the highlight of the program and was made by Bob Nelson, president of the

Mantle Signs 6th \$100,000 Contract

By DICK COUCH

Associated Press Sports Writer

Mickey Mantle, veteran star of the New York Yankees, signed his sixth consecutive \$100,000 contract Tuesday and promptly set his sights on moving into third place on the all-time home run list.

"I think I can hit 30 home runs. I don't think that's out of the question," said the 36-year-old Mantle, who made a successful transition last season from center field to first base.

Mantle hit 22 homers last year, giving him a lifetime total of 518. Ahead of him are Babe Ruth with 714, Willie Mays 564, Jimmy Fox 534 and Ted Williams, 521. Of the four, only Mays is still playing.

Mantle, who will be starting his 18th season with the Yanks, posted a .245 batting mark — his career low — in 1967. He played in 144 games, though, more than any other member of the team.

He is not proud of his performance. "I can't do any worse than last year," he said. "In some games, I think I was hurtin' the team by playing. This year I'll settle for about 125 games."

The three-time American League Most Valuable Player speculated that he would play

about five innings during the exhibition games.

"There's still a lot I've got to learn about playing first base," he said. "But I'm going to take it a little easier this spring. A year ago, I worked harder and then pulled a leg muscle in the opening game of the season. I don't want that to happen again."

Donaldson Leads Coronado Meet

Betty Donaldson of the Coronado Women's Golf Association is the leader of the Hinson's Jewelry tournament with a net 67.

Final play of the tournament will get under way Thursday at the Coronado Country Club at 9 a.m. Pairings will be made at the pro shop.

Men's Club, who also gave credit to Bob Bendalin and Irv Prell, co-chairmen for the event.

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